

Purpose: To help us feel the powerful witness of the Savior in the Doctrine and Covenants and to strengthen our testimony of the Savior’s Atonement.

Of the Atonement of Jesus Christ, Elder Boyd K. Packer said: “This truth is the very root of Christian doctrine. You may know much as it branches out from there, but if you only know the branches and those branches do not touch that root, if they have been cut free from that truth, there will be no life nor substance nor redemption in them.” (“The Mediator, Ensign, May 1977, 56)

1. The Doctrine and Covenants testifies of Jesus Christ.

The Doctrine and Covenants is a testament of Jesus Christ given in this dispensation.

Explanatory Introduction: 8th paragraph, Last sentence.

D&C 50:41-44 “never fall” ▶ D&C 76:22-24

2. Jesus Christ “suffered the pain of all men, that all men might repent and come unto him.”

The only scripture where our Savior describes his own atoning suffering: ▶ D&C 19:15-18

Why? ▶ D&C 18:10-11 ▶ 19:19 ▶ 19:24 ▶ 34:3

Through the Atonement, we will all be resurrected: ▶ 88:14-18 ▶ 93:33

Through the Atonement, we can be forgiven: ▶ 18:11-12 ▶ 19:16-17, 20 ▶ 58:42

Through the Atonement, we can inherit celestial glory: ▶ 76:62-70 (esp. v69 “just men *made* perfect)

Through the Atonement, Christ gained perfect empathy for us in all our sorrows, pains, and afflictions:

▶ D&C 122:1-9 (esp. v8)

↔ See Elder Neal A. Maxwell ↔ Stephen E. Robinson

↔ Elder Jeffrey R. Holland

Elder Jeffrey R. Holland said: “When ... difficult times come to us, we can remember that Jesus had to descend below all things before He could ascend above them, and that He suffered pains and afflictions and temptations of every kind that He might be filled with mercy and know how to succor His people in their infirmities (see D&C 88:6; Alma 7:11-12).” (Ensign, Nov. 1995, 69)

WHEN HAVE YOU FELT THE POWER OF THE ATONEMENT IN YOUR LIFE?

HOW CAN WE SHOW THE SAVIOR OUR GRATITUDE FOR HIS ATONEMENT?

HOW SHOULD OUR UNDERSTANDING OF THE ATONEMENT AFFECT US IN OUR DAILY LIVES?

3. The Doctrine and Covenants helps us understand the Savior’s roles and attributes.

To exercise faith in God, we must have “a correct idea of his character, perfections, and attributes.” (Lectures on Faith, 38)

WHAT ATTRIBUTES OF THE SAVIOR DO YOU SEE IN THE PASSAGES WE HAVE READ TODAY?

WHAT ROLES AND ATTRIBUTES OF THE SAVIOR CAN YOU FIND IN THE FOLLOWING PASSAGES?

D&C 6:20-21

D&C 6:32-37

D&C 19:1-3

D&C 29:1-2

D&C 38:1-3

D&C 43:34

D&C 45:3-5

D&C 50:44

D&C 76:5

D&C 93:5-19

D&C 133:42-52

D&C 136:22

D&C 19:23—“Learn of me and listen to my words; walk in the meekness of my Spirit, and you shall have peace in me.”
As we study the Doctrine and Covenants, “look for what it teaches about Jesus Christ.”

President Joseph Field Smith: “No member of this Church can stand approved in the presence of God who has not seriously and carefully read the Book of Mormon.” (In Conference Report, Oct. 1961, 18)

President Ezra Taft Benson: “The Book of Mormon is studied in our Sunday School and seminary classes every fourth year. This four-year pattern, however, must *not* be followed by Church members in their personal and family study. We need to read daily from the pages of the book that will get a man ‘nearer to God by abiding by its precepts, than any other book’ (*Ensign*, Nov. 1988, 4)

Elder Neal A. Maxwell: “All our infirmities and sicknesses were somehow, too, a part of the awful arithmetic of the Atonement.... His suffering—as it were *enormity* multiplied by *infinity*—evoked His later soul-cry on the cross, and it was a cry of forsakenness.” (“Willing to Submit,” *Ensign*, May 1985, 73)

Stephen E. Robinson: “God uses no magic wand to simply wave bad things into nonexistence. The sins that he remits, he remits by making them his own and suffering them. The pain and heartaches that he relieves, he relieves by suffering them himself. These things can be shared and absorbed, but they cannot be simply wished or waved away. They must be suffered. Thus we owe him not only for our spiritual cleansing from sin, but for our physical, mental, and emotional healings as well, for he has born these infirmities for us as well.” (*Believing Christ*, Deseret Book, 1992, 123)

Elder Jeffrey R. Holland: “The Savior said, ‘Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you... Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid’ (John 14:27).

“I submit to you, that may be one of the Savior’s commandments that is, even in the hearts of otherwise faithful Latter-day Saints, almost universally disobeyed; and yet I wonder whether our resistance to this invitation could be any more grievous to the Lord’s merciful heart. I can tell you this as a parent: as concerned as I would be if somewhere in their lives one of my children were seriously troubled or unhappy or disobedient, nevertheless I would be infinitely

more devastated if I felt that at such a time that child could not trust me to help or thought his or her interest was unimportant to me or unsafe in my care. In that same spirit, I am convinced that none of us can appreciate how deeply it wounds the loving heart of the Savior of the world when he finds that his people do not feel confident in his care or secure in his hands or trust in his commandments.” (“Come unto Me,” *Ensign*, Apr. 1998, 19)

Dr. Neil Flinders said in one of my classes at BYU: “Submission to God is *not* the same thing as commitment to him. Submission is greater than commitment. Submission is to surrender one’s will to him, and then he will direct our lives for good. Both submission and commitment can be measured by activity in church, but ultimate happiness, personal peace and spiritual fulfillment will attend only submission.” (In my class notes)

Laurie Tueller spoke at a Timpanogos Stake Conference and “described the terrible ordeal of losing her baby Amanda to chronic kidney failure. At Primary Children’s Hospital, the doctor gave her the crushing news in a briefing room. After leaving her alone, she fell to her knees and pleaded with God, asking him not to take her baby. She told him she could not handle such a trial. Of her pain she said, ‘I felt the most heavy darkness in my soul.’

“Nevertheless, she said, ‘After several discussions with my husband and many sincere prayers, I finally concluded that if it was God’s will that Amanda should die, then I would be willing to give her up.’

“Laurie testified of our Father’s transcendent love by saying, ‘When I finally allowed myself to submit to God’s will, I felt an overwhelming sense of peace. That heavy darkness was replaced by a calm and reassuring peace that came flooding over me. And I wish I could describe that feeling to you. The fear left me, and I felt the love and concern of my Heavenly Father.’

“Some months later, Amanda passed away in Primary Children’s Intensive Care Unit. But our Heavenly Father healed Laurie’s heart, and she said, ‘I can testify to you, I have never felt the Spirit as strong as I did that night as Amanda passed through the veil. It was such a beautiful and sacred experience. And despite all the tears, I felt such a great peace. And it was during this greatest trial that I felt my Savior the closest.’” (In *Prayers That Bring Miracles*, Aspen Books, 1997, 31-32)